

them by following the procedure outlined for the Guest Account above.

Note that some software installations will create a user account for their own purposes. For example, installing the .NET Framework will create an user account called ASPNET. These types of accounts are system accounts and should not be modified or deleted unless the associated software has been removed or is no longer needed. Normally, uninstalling the software should also remove the account.

2.10. Disable unnecessary services

When Windows XP starts, a number of programs start as part of the core operating system. These are generally known as “services”. Typically, Windows XP will also have a number of services that are non-critical but running in the background, consuming system resources. There is also a potential security hazard as these services, especially the lesser known ones, could have some as-yet undiscovered vulnerability which could be exploited. Disable all but the most essential services.

To view the list of running services, type in “services.msc” at a command prompt. Click on the Status column heading and sort the list to view all running services. Some viruses and Trojans sneak into the system and install themselves as legitimate-looking services. Review the description of each running service to get a basic understanding of what it does. You can selectively stop a service, set it to start Manually (when invoked by another program), Automatically start with Windows, or Disable it entirely. The following services are typically safe to disable:

- Telnet
- Universal Plug and Play Device Host
- IIS (not installed by default)
- NetMeeting Remote Desktop Sharing
- Remote Desktop Help Session Manager